Mikhael E. Hayes

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Interests

Phonology, Poetic Rhyme, Subregular Computation, Basque, Language Change

Education

2023 – Present
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign – Urbana, IL
PhD in Linguistics (Expected May 2028), MA in Linguistics (May 2025)
Certificate in Romance Linguistics
GPA: 3.98

2019 – 2023
Indiana University Bloomington – Bloomington, IN
BA in Linguistics, BA in Hispanic Linguistics; Minor in Human-Centered Computing
GPA: 3.98

Writing

Accepted April 2026
Quantifying Aspiration in Zuberoan Basque
With José Ignacio Hualde, for *Anuario del Seminario de Filología Vasca "Julio de Urquijo"* (ASJU).

April 2026
***Raddoppiamento Sintattico* in Logical Phonology**
Available on lingbuzz.

In peer review
Computing Rhyme: A Tier-Based Strictly Local Approach to Poetic Rhyme as Harmony
With Scott Nelson, for *Glossa*.

In progress
Sounds, the same but different: A Tier-Based Strictly Local Unification of English Rhyme and Chinese Tonal Contrast in Poetry

Presenting

January 2026
Poetic Rhyme as a Tier-Based Strictly Local Constraint
Poster at the *2026 Linguistic Society of America Annual Meeting* (LSA), New Orleans (with Scott Nelson).

November 2025
Aspiration and its Historical Sources: Quantifying Aspiration in Zuberoan Basque
Talk at the *First International Conference on the History of Basque* (ICHB1), University of the Basque Country.

November 2025
Computing Rhyme
Talk at the *2025 Rutgers Subregular Morphophonology Workshop*, Rutgers University.

October 2025
Aspiration and its Historical Sources: Quantifying Aspiration in Zuberoan Basque
Poster at the *29th Mid-Continental Phonetics and Phonology Conference* (MidPhon 29), Indiana University.

November 2024 **Tell it to me straight: Refusals in comparative pragmatics**
Talk at *Pragmatics and Language Learning* (PLL), Indiana University.

Research

Fall 2026 **Research Centre for Basque Language and Texts** – Bayonne, France
Visiting researcher at IKER (CNRS UMR5478); experimentation on rhyme phonology in Basque oral poetry (*bertsolaritza*).

August 2025 **Caucasian Languages in Georgia** – Zemo Alvani, Georgia
Student in the CauLaGe summer program; researching and documenting Tsova-Tush (Nakh-Daghestani); analysis of poetic rhyme.

2021 – 2023 **Pragmatics & Discourse at IU** – Bloomington, IN
Research assistant; audio processing, transcription, data entry for Spanish/English pragmatics research; copyediting; website maintenance.

Summer 2021 **The Language Conservancy** – Bloomington, IN
Linguistics intern; revitalization work for Cowlitz Coast Salish (x̌ʷpúlmixq); lemma revision in Cowlitz-English bilingual dictionary.

Courses

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

Spring 2026 **Instructor of Record, LING 210: Language History**
Lead lectures and discussions; design syllabus and materials; evaluate student progress.

Spring 2026 **Teaching Assistant, LING 302: Elements of Phonology**
Lead review sessions and assist students in office hours.

Fall 2025 **Instructor of Record, LING 210: Language History**
Lead lectures and discussions; design syllabus and course materials.

Fall 2025 **Grader, LING 502: Phonology I**
Evaluate graduate-level assignments and provide feedback.

Spring 2025 **Teaching Assistant, LING 225: Language, Mind, and Brain**
Lead discussion seminars in psycholinguistics.

Fall 2024 **Teaching Assistant, LING 100: Intro to Language Science**
Facilitate discussion-based learning for introductory linguistics.

Indiana University Bloomington

Summer 2022 **Undergraduate Teaching Assistant, SLST-S 135: Foundations of the American Experience**
Assist international students in acclimating to American academia (with Rex Sprouse).

Fall 2021 **Undergraduate Teaching Assistant, LING-L 307: Phonology**
Facilitate learning of foundational phonology concepts; assist in office hours (with Stuart Davis).

Fall 2020 **Undergraduate Teaching Assistant, LING-L 103: Intro to Linguistic Analysis**
Facilitate learning of fundamental linguistic concepts (with Ann Bunger).

Honors

Fall 2026	Chateaubriand Fellowship (Embassy of France in the United States)
2023 – Present	Community of Scholars Fellowship (UIUC)
2022 – Present	Phi Beta Kappa (ΦΒΚ)
2021 – 2023	Sigma Delta Pi (ΣΔΠ) Spanish Honors Society, Vice-President (IU)
2019 – 2023	Adam W. Herbert Presidential Scholar (IU)
2019 – 2023	Founders Scholar for Sustained Academic Excellence (IU)
2019 – 2023	Executive Dean's List (IU)
2020 – 2023	Hispanic Scholarship Fund Scholar

Involvement

2026 – Present **Alphabetter: macOS IPA Input Utility, developer**
Develop a free macOS utility for International Phonetic Alphabet (IPA) input for linguists.

2026 **The Vineyard Food Pantry at the Hope Center, weekly volunteer**
Pack and distribute food to those in need.

2024 – Present **Phonetics and Phonology Forum, and Historical Reading Group (UIUC), member**
Participate in academic reading groups and present own research.

2023 – Present **Twin City Bible Church, small group leader**
Lead academic and spiritual discussions of the Bible, coordinate practical service opportunities.

2019 – 2023 **Honors Student Organization (IU), Vice President**
Coordinate events for the Hutton community; manage budgets and local business relations.

Spring 2022 **Universidad Complutense de Madrid (UCM), student**
Study abroad for a semester in Madrid, Spain

2021 – 2022 **Hutton Honors College Funding Board (IU), member**
Review student organization funding petitions.

Fall 2020 **Feedback Assistant (IU)**
Provide linguistic feedback and speech improvement critiques for international teaching applicants (TEPAIC).

Skills

Technical Skills
Audio editing/transcription, copyediting, website maintenance, analytical research, LaTeX, Git, Swift, Python, R.

Languages
English (native), Spanish (heritage/bilingual), Italian (limited), Basque (limited), French (limited).